# Igor B. Martins

Postdoctoral Researcher at Linköping University, also affiliated with Lund University

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## Academic Experience

2020– **Postdoctoral Researcher**

Linköping University Sweden 2026–
Lund University Sweden 2023–2026
University of Cambridge United Kingdom 2022–2023
Lund University Sweden 2020–2022

2017–2018 **Visiting Researcher**

Stellenbosch University South Africa

## Education

2016–2020 **Ph.D., Economic History**

Lund University Sweden

2014–2016 **M.Sc., Economic History**

Lund University Sweden

2008–2011 **B.Sc., Economics**

Fundação Getulio Vargas Brazil

## Published works

- **Martins, I.** (forthcoming). Living Standards in Ghana, 1955–2005, in G. Austin, A. Britwum, L. Doumbia, A. Eckert, & N.Y. Sapong (eds), *Labour and Work in Ghana Since Independence*, London: Bloomsbury Academic.
- **Martins, I.**, & Green, E. (forthcoming). Från arbetskraft till kapital: Slaveriets ekonomiska logik i globalt perspektiv, *Statsvetenskaplig tidskrift*.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Capital and Coercion: Slavery after the 1807 import ban in the Cape Colony, *European Review of Economic History*, heag012.
- **Martins, I.**, & Green, E. (2026). Theoretical Foundations of the Economics of Slavery: Enslaved people as capital investments in the Atlantic world, *Journal of Global History*, vol. 21, no. 1, pp.22–40.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). Is the Business of Conquest the Conquest of Business?, *The Case Centre*, 225-0045-1.
- Cilliers, J., Mariotti, M., & **Martins, I.** (2024). Fertility Responses to Short-Term Economic Stress: Price volatility and wealth shocks in a pre-transitional settler colony, *Explorations in Economic History*, 101620.

- Axelsson, T., & **Martins, I.** (2024). Resilience to Shrinking as a Catch-up Strategy: A comparison of Brazil and Indonesia, 1964–2019, *Studies in Comparative International Development*, vol. 59, no. 3, pp.491–516.
- Smythe, A., **Martins, I.**, & Andersson, M. (2024). Inequality, Poverty, and Resilience to Economic Shrinking, *International Journal of Development Issues*, vol. 23, no. 1, pp.40–81.
- **Martins, I.**, & Schwaag Serger, S. (2023). An Age of Disentangled Research?, *Issues in Science and Technology*, vol. 40, no. 1, pp.38–43.
- **Martins, I.**, Cilliers, J., & Fourie, J. (2023). Legacies of Loss: The health outcomes of slaveholder compensation in the British Cape Colony, *Explorations in Economic History*, 101506.
- **Martins, I.**, & Schwaag Serger, S. (2023). *Shifting Patterns in International Research Cooperation*, Stockholm: STINT.
- **Martins, I.** (2020). Collateral Effect: Slavery and wealth in the Cape Colony, PhD thesis, Department of Economic History, Lund University.
- Palacio, A., & **Martins, I.** (2019). What Caused Poverty Reduction in Brazil During the 2000s: Sectoral growth or public expenditures, *OASIS. Observatorio de Análisis de los Sistemas Internacionales*, no. 31, pp.185–213.
- Palacio, A., & **Martins, I.** (2018). Poverty and Democracy: The Brazilian experience, in D. Rauhut & N. Hatti (eds), *Poverty, Politics and the Poverty of Politics*, New Delhi: B.R. Publishing Corporation, pp.193–210.

## Works under review

- **Martins, I.** (2026). The Case for Artisanal Doctoral Supervision, *Studies in Higher Education*. Revise & Resubmit.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Retrieval-Restricted Reasoning: Supporting Scholarly Synthesis with Language Models, *Historical Methods: A Journal of Quantitative and Interdisciplinary History*. Revise & Resubmit.
- **Martins, I.**, Grab, S., & Green, E. (2026). Weather as a vector of inequality, *Nature Communications*. Revise & Resubmit.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Slave Emancipation and Agricultural Output in the Cape Colony, *Cliometrica*. Submitted.
- Makuei, J., & **Martins, I.** (2026). Democracy and Rural Inequality in Kenya, 1997–2010, *African Affairs*. Submitted.

## Work in progress

- **Martins, I.** Income Inequality in Late Colonial Angola, 1940–1970.
- Cilliers, J., & **Martins, I.** Wealth and Adult Mortality in a Pre-Industrial Settler Society: Evidence from Cape Probate Inventories.
- **Martins, I.**, Schoots, J., & Green, E. Held by the Elite: Monopoly Rights and Family Fortunes at the Cape of Good Hope, 1680–1794.
- Smythe, A., & **Martins, I.** Catch-up and Resilience to Shrinking, 1890–2019.
- Cilliers, J., & **Martins, I.** Forebearers: The forgotten women of the Cape Colony.
- **Martins, I.**, & Green, E. What Are Institutions Made Of? A social contract approach.

- **Martins, I.**, Aboagye, P., & Austin, G. The Ghanaian Divergence: Prices, incomes and living standards after independence.

## External funding

2027–2029 **Handelsbanken Research Foundations**
Flying Blind: Tsetse Ecology, Colonial Response and Long-Run Health in Southeast Africa (P26-0357) Project researcher. Engaged at 30% for three years.
SEK 1,500,000 (≈ EUR 138,500 / USD 163,000)

2024–2027 **Vetenskapsrådet**
Causes and Consequences of Long-Term Inequality: Africa's Levels and Trends (2023-00809_VR) Project researcher. Engaged at 20% for two years.
SEK 6,737,000 (≈ EUR 623,623 / USD 735,688)

2022–2026 **Handelsbanken Research Foundations**
Resilience to Economic Shrinking: The Role of Autonomous Financial Systems (P21-0044) Project researcher. Engaged at approx. 30% for two years.
SEK 1,725,000 (≈ EUR 150,000 / USD 164,000)

2022–2025 **Arts and Humanities Research Council (UK)**
Where have all the Workers Gone? Labour and Work in Ghana, 1951–2010 (AH/W010852/1) Postdoctoral Research Associate. Engaged at 100% for one year.
SEK 3,332,000 (≈ EUR 308,438 / GBP 268,859)

2021–2026 **Riksbankens Jubileumsfond**
The establishment, growth and legacy of a settler colony: Quantitative panel studies of the political economy of the Cape Colony (M20-0041) Project researcher. Engaged at 40% for four years (2021–2024) and 20% for two years (2025–2026).
SEK 29,000,000 (≈ EUR 2,520,000 / USD 2,760,000)

2017–2018 **Erasmus Mundus Action 2 Programme (INSPIRE)**
Scholarship Stellenbosch University, South Africa
Supported research training on the economic history of the Cape Colony.
SEK 157,000

## Teaching experience

2025– **Development in a Historical Perspective - Economic, Social and Political Transformation**
Lund University Course convener

2023–2026 **Growth, Stagnation, and Inequality in Africa**
Lund University Course convener

2019– **Colonialism and Economic Change in Africa, Asia and Latin America**
Lund University Lecturer

2019–2026 **The Art of Writing and Reporting**
Lund University Course convener

2019–2026 **Field Work/Internship and Research Overview**
Lund University Course convener

## Pedagogical qualifications

2025 **Course design in higher education**
The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2024 **Doctoral supervision**
The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2022 **Teaching and learning in higher education II**
The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2021 **Teaching and learning in higher education I**
The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2020 **How to teach with cases**
Lund University School of Economics and Management Lund University, Sweden

2019 **How to write cases**
Lund University School of Economics and Management Lund University, Sweden

## Supervision

2023–2026 **Doctoral**
Benjamin Chatterton, PhD in Economic History Lund University
Co-supervisor
Expected completion November 2026

2021– **Master's**
14 theses in Economic History Lund University

2019– **Bachelor's**
7 theses in Economic History Lund University

## Awards

2020 **Teacher of the Year**
Lund University School of Economics and Management

## Media Outreach

- **Martins, I.** (2026). Assessing students' academic writing when AI can produce a first draft, *Times Higher Education*.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Using Portuguese Sources to Build an Angolan Social Table, *African Long-Term Inequality Trends (AFLIT)*.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Capital and Coercion: Why Slavery Persisted after Britain Banned the Trade, *European Historical Economics Society*.
- **Martins, I.**, & Green, E. (2026). Theoretical Foundations of the Economics of Slavery: Enslaved people as capital investments in the Atlantic world, *Frontiers in African Economic History Blog*.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). Devo, não nego, pago com o meu escravo - Como pessoas escravizadas viravam garantia de crédito, *The Conversation Brasil*.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). What Is Economic History?, *Tell Me About* [podcast].
- **Martins, I.** (2025). Students Learn Best When They're Not Handed a Map: 4 steps to structure discomfort in your case classroom, *Inspiring Minds*.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). The Pressure to Quantify Research Is Erasing Conceptual Depth, *LSE Impact Blog*.
- Kim, H., Schwaag Serger, S., Mobrand, E., & **Martins, I.** (2024). International Science Is Having a Messy Breakup, *Research Professional News*.
- **Martins, I.** (2023). Does a Negative Wealth Shock Affect Your Health? Evidence from an episode of 'Expropriation with Partial Compensation' in nineteenth-century South Africa, *Our Long Walk: Reflections on South Africa, from an Economic History Perspective*.
- **Martins, I.**, Cilliers, J., & Fourie, J. (2023). Legacies of Loss: The health outcomes of slaveholder compensation in the British Cape Colony, *Frontiers in African Economic History Blog*.

## Editorial and Review Experience

2026– **Editor**
Frontiers in African Economic History
Blog of the African Economic History Network. Weekly curation of Africa-related articles across eight journals, commissioning and editing of blog essays, and coordination of the editorial workflow.

2026– **Peer-reviewer**
Studies in Higher Education

2025 **Peer-reviewer**
International Journal of Development Issues

2025 **Peer-reviewer**
Asia-Pacific Economic History Review

2024 **Peer-reviewer**
Studies in Comparative International Development

2023 **Peer-reviewer**
Technological Forecasting and Social Change

## Service

2026– **International Economic History Association**
Secretariat
Supports the Secretary General with the administration of the association and the preparation of the World Economic History Congress, and keeps the record of Executive Committee meetings.

2025–2026 **United Nations Development Programme**
Consultant
Commissioned by the UNDP's Strategy, Policy and Capacities for Economic Management (SPACE) Unit of South Sudan as a consultant to the country's first Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI) report.

2023– **Swedish Economic History Association**
Auditor
The SEHA promotes the spread of knowledge about economic and social history, as well as historical and geographical research. The association organises lectures and conferences.

2023–2025 **World Economic History Congress 2025**
Lund, Sweden
Conference Manager
Co-organised the 19th WEHC, a major international conference in economic history with more than 1,100 participants. Contributed to programme coordination, hybrid participation logistics, volunteer management, statistical reporting, and post-conference analysis. Oversaw technical workflows, communication, and strategic structuring of the scientific and cultural programme.

2023–2024 **The Swedish Foundation for International Cooperation in Research and Higher Education (STINT)**
Consultant
STINT supports internationalisation in Swedish higher education by funding initiatives led by researchers, educators, and academic leaders.

2022–2023 **Clare Hall** Affiliated Postdoctoral Member
Clare Hall is a constituent college of the University of Cambridge established to serve as an Institute of Advanced Studies.

2021–2023 **Swedish Economic History Association**
Treasurer

2017– **Laboratory for the Economics of Africa's Past**
Stellenbosch University
Visiting Researcher
The Laboratory for the Economics of Africa's Past is dedicated to the quantitative study of African economic and social history.

## Professional memberships

Economic History Association, Economic History Society, Social Science History Association, African Economic History Network, Swedish Economic History Association

## Recent conferences, workshops and seminars

03/2027 **Trelleborgs Biblioteket**
Trelleborg, Sweden **Speaker** (scheduled)
What is the difference between colonialism and globalisation?

10/2026 **African Economic History Network annual meeting**
University of Gothenburg, Sweden **Panellist**
Weather as a vector of inequality

02/2026 **Trelleborgs Biblioteket**
Trelleborg, Sweden **Speaker**
How did colonial institutions shape African democracy and development?

07/2025 **World Economic History Congress**
Lund, Sweden **Organiser & Panellist**
The geography of development in Portuguese Africa: Lessons from Angola

12/2024 **African Studies Association**
Chicago, USA **Panellist**
Market Integration and the Development of Capitalism in Ghana, 1987–2005

12/2023 **Utbildningsdepartementet**
Stockholm, Sweden **Panellist**
Shifting patterns in international research collaboration

09/2023 **Seminarium om förändrade mönster för internationella forskningssamarbeten**
Stockholm, Sweden **Panellist**
Shifting patterns in international research collaboration

09/2023 **Swedish Economic History meeting**
Lund, Sweden **Organizer & Panellist**
Catch-up and Resilience to Shrinking, 1890–2019

03/2023 **African Economic History Seminar**
Cambridge, United Kingdom **Panellist**
Raising capital to raise crops: Slave emancipation and agricultural output in the Cape Colony

## Selected earlier conferences (2017–2022)

10/2022 **African Economic History Network annual meeting**
Tenerife, Spain **Panellist**

07/2022 **World Economic History Congress**
Paris, France **Panellist**

10/2021 **Swedish Economic History meeting**
Gothenburg, Sweden **Panellist**

10/2019 **Swedish Economic History meeting**
Uppsala, Sweden **Panellist**

01/2019 **Allied Social Sciences Association**
Atlanta, USA **Panellist**

10/2018 **African Economic History Network annual meeting**
Bologna, Italy **Panellist**

07/2018 **World Economic History Congress**
Boston, USA **Panellist**

04/2018 **European Social Science History Conference**
Belfast, UK **Panellist**

10/2017 **African Economic History Network annual meeting**
Stellenbosch, South Africa **Panellist**

## Administrative references

**Prof. Mats Olsson**
Lund University, Sweden
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**Prof. Leigh Gardner**
London School of Economics, UK
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## Academic references

**Prof. Erik Green**
Lund University, Sweden
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**Prof. Gareth Austin**
University of Cambridge, UK
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**Prof. Anne McCants**
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**Prof. Jeanne Cilliers**
Linköping University, Sweden
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## Teaching references

**Dr. Tobias Axelsson**
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**Assoc. Prof. Tobias Karlsson**
Lund University, Sweden
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